

# Pre-Lecture Analysis Sheet

Week 3 · Pulse Diagnosis 脈診 — 28 Qualities, Positions, Seasonal Pulses

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## How to use this sheet:

**Before lecture** → complete Sections A-D and the pre-lecture case questions. Rate your confidence honestly.

**During lecture** → annotate directly — add answers, corrections, and new insights in the lined spaces.

**After lecture** → complete Section F, update confidence ratings, and finish the clinical case.

Name: \_\_\_\_\_ Date: \_\_\_\_\_

EAM310

Week 3

Summer 2026

## A · Learning Targets — I Can Statements

Rate your confidence before lecture (Pre) and after lecture (Post) by circling a number 1–5. 1 = can't do it yet · 5 = fully confident

| I Can Statement                                                                                                        | Pre-Lecture Confidence          | Post-Lecture Confidence         |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| Name the three qualities of a normal pulse (Stomach-Qi, Spirit, Root) and explain what each reflects physiologically.  | Pre 1 2 3 4 5<br>Post 1 2 3 4 5 | Pre 1 2 3 4 5<br>Post 1 2 3 4 5 |
| Locate all six cun-guan-chi positions (left and right) and state the organ assigned to each.                           | Pre 1 2 3 4 5<br>Post 1 2 3 4 5 | Pre 1 2 3 4 5<br>Post 1 2 3 4 5 |
| Classify all 28 pulse qualities into their six groupings (Depth, Rate, Strength, Size, Length, Shape, Rhythm).         | Pre 1 2 3 4 5<br>Post 1 2 3 4 5 | Pre 1 2 3 4 5<br>Post 1 2 3 4 5 |
| Discriminate Knotted, Hasty, and Intermittent pulses by rate and regularity of stops.                                  | Pre 1 2 3 4 5<br>Post 1 2 3 4 5 | Pre 1 2 3 4 5<br>Post 1 2 3 4 5 |
| State the normal seasonal pulse for all four seasons including date ranges (Wiry / Flooding / Hair-like / Stone-like). | Pre 1 2 3 4 5<br>Post 1 2 3 4 5 | Pre 1 2 3 4 5<br>Post 1 2 3 4 5 |
| Given a clinical presentation, predict the expected pulse quality and confirm it at the correct organ position.        | Pre 1 2 3 4 5<br>Post 1 2 3 4 5 | Pre 1 2 3 4 5<br>Post 1 2 3 4 5 |

## B · Activate — Connect to What You Know

### B1 · From Week 2 to Today

Week 2 covered the Eight Principles and introduced tongue and pulse positions. Today Week 3 goes deep on the 28 pulse qualities — you will learn to feel what each quality describes, what pattern it indicates, and how position × quality together produce a diagnosis.

**What do you already know about pulse diagnosis? Write whatever comes to mind:**

### B2 · Connect the Dots

How do each of these prior-week concepts connect to today's pulse content?

|                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Eight Principles: Exterior pattern → what pulse quality would you expect at the surface?</b> <div></div> <div></div> | <b>Cold vs. Heat → which produces Slow pulse and which Rapid? Why?</b> <div></div> <div></div>                 |
| <b>Qi Deficiency (Week 1) → which pulse quality most likely? Why?</b> <div></div> <div></div>                           | <b>Phlegm / Dampness → what is the classic pulse quality? (Hint: Week 2 quick ref)</b> <div></div> <div></div> |

## C · Vocabulary Pre-Load — Define Before Class

Fill in your definition / feel / mnemonic before lecture. Refine during and after class. Blank = opportunity to learn it live.

| Character | Pinyin       | English               | My Definition / Feel / Clinical Note |
|-----------|--------------|-----------------------|--------------------------------------|
| 脈診        | Mài Zhěn     | Pulse Diagnosis       |                                      |
| 浮脈        | Fú Mài       | Floating Pulse        |                                      |
| 沉脈        | Chén Mài     | Deep Pulse            |                                      |
| 遲脈        | Chí Mài      | Slow Pulse            |                                      |
| 數脈        | Shuò Mài     | Rapid Pulse           |                                      |
| 滑脈        | Huá Mài      | Slippery Pulse        |                                      |
| 澀脈        | Sè Mài       | Choppy Pulse          |                                      |
| 弦脈        | Xián Mài     | Wiry Pulse            |                                      |
| 緊脈        | Jǐn Mài      | Tight Pulse           |                                      |
| 芤脈        | Kōu Mài      | Hollow Pulse          |                                      |
| 結脈        | Jié Mài      | Knotted Pulse         |                                      |
| 促脈        | Cù Mài       | Hasty Pulse           |                                      |
| 代脈        | Dài Mài      | Intermittent Pulse    |                                      |
| 胃氣        | Wèi Qì       | Stomach-Qi (in pulse) |                                      |
| 寸關尺       | Cùn Guān Chǐ | Three Pulse Positions |                                      |

## D · Anticipatory Questions — Answer During Lecture

Leave blank before lecture — fill in the answers as the material is covered. Expand after class.

### Normal Pulse & Positions 正常脈 · 脈位

#### Q1 · THE THREE QUALITIES OF A NORMAL PULSE ★

What are the three essential qualities every normal pulse must have, and what does each one reflect about the patient's fundamental health?

Hint: Three qualities — not four. Which reflects the Heart? The Kidney? Slide 172.

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## Q2 · THE SIX POSITIONS ★

Complete the pulse position table — try from memory first, then verify from the lecture:

| Position              | Left Hand — Organ(s) | Right Hand — Organ(s) |
|-----------------------|----------------------|-----------------------|
| 寸 Cun (1st · Index)   |                      |                       |
| 關 Guan (2nd · Middle) |                      |                       |
| 尺 Chi (3rd · Ring)    |                      |                       |

### Depth, Rate & Shape

## Q3 · FLOATING VS. DEEP — AND THEIR COMBINATIONS ★

What does a Floating pulse indicate? What changes the meaning when combined with Empty at depth? Then: what does Deep + Weak indicate vs. Deep + Full?

Hint: Floating also indicates Yin def when Empty at depth. Slides 177–181.

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## Q4 · RAPID & SLOW COMBINATIONS ★

Rapid + Full vs. Rapid + Empty — explain both. Then Slow + Weak vs. Slow + Full.

Hint: Full-Heat vs. Empty-Heat; Empty-Cold vs. Full-Cold. Slides 182–185.

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## Q5 · WIRY VS. TIGHT ★

Both feel taut. What is the textural difference — and what does each primarily indicate? When is Wiry completely normal?

Hint: Wiry = bowstring; Tight = twisted rope. One has a seasonal context. Slides 203–206.

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### Rhythm Irregulars & Seasonal Pulses

## Q6 · KNOTTED / HASTY / INTERMITTENT ★★

Fill in during lecture:

| Pulse          | Rate | Stops are... | Primary Indication | Severity |
|----------------|------|--------------|--------------------|----------|
| Knotted 結      |      |              |                    |          |
| Hasty 促        |      |              |                    |          |
| Intermittent 代 |      |              |                    |          |

## Q7 · HOLLOW PULSE ★

Describe the three-level finding of the Hollow pulse and the clinical emergency it signals.

Hint: Present at surface + deep, empty in middle. Like pressing a scallion stalk. Slide 209.

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Q8 · SEASONAL PULSES — ALL FOUR ★★ (SCHRIER: "GOOD QUIZ QUESTION — WINK WINK NUDGE NUDGE")

Fill in each season's expected normal pulse AND date range during lecture:

| Season   | Date Range | Normal Pulse Quality | Physiological Rationale (Yang Qi movement) |
|----------|------------|----------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| Spring 春 |            |                      |                                            |
| Summer 夏 |            |                      |                                            |
| Autumn 秋 |            |                      |                                            |
| Winter 冬 |            |                      |                                            |

Q9 · SIX CLIMATIC QI → PULSE SIGNATURES

Which pulse does each pathogen produce? Fill in from the Seasonal Pulses slide deck:

| Pathogen (六淫) | Expected Pulse Quality |
|---------------|------------------------|
| Wind 風        |                        |
| Cold 寒        |                        |
| Summer-Heat 暑 |                        |
| Dampness 濕    |                        |
| Dryness 燥     |                        |
| Fire / Heat 火 |                        |

Q10 · POSITION + QUALITY = DIAGNOSIS

A Wiry pulse only at Left Guan means something very different from Wiry everywhere. Why does position matter as much as quality? What would Left Guan Wiry specifically suggest?

Hint: Left Guan = Liver/Gallbladder. Position localizes the pattern to the organ.

E · Clinical Case — Apply It Before & After

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Case Vignette: Ms. Lin, 34-year-old competitive Latin dancer

Ms. Lin presents with a **3-month history of chronic fatigue and lower back soreness**. She trains 6 days/week, 4–5 hours per session. She reports **dizziness when standing quickly, blurred vision, dry eyes**, and **night sweats**. She is rarely thirsty; prefers room-temperature water. Her menstrual cycle is irregular — **periods are late and scanty**. Examination: tongue is **pale and slightly dry, thin coat**. You palpate her radial pulse.

Fatigue 3 mo

Low back soreness

Dizziness on standing

Night sweats

Blurred vision · dry eyes

Scanty late periods

Tongue: pale, slightly dry

Room-temp water

Pre-Lecture Questions — Answer Based on Your Current Knowledge

Before the lecture, do your best with these. Guessing is fine — it primes your brain to receive the lecture material.

**PRE · Q1**

What pulse quality or qualities would you most expect to feel in Ms. Lin — and at which position(s)? Explain your reasoning.

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**PRE · Q2**

Using Eight Principles from Week 2: Interior or Exterior? Deficiency or Excess? What evidence supports your answer?

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**PRE · Q3**

Night sweats + blurred vision in a young female dancer — name the pattern you suspect and the Vital Substance most likely depleted.

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**Post-Lecture Questions — Complete After Class**

**POST · Q1**

State the specific pulse quality you would expect at each of Ms. Lin's six positions. Explain what pattern each finding points to. (Use cun/guan/chi × left/right format.)

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**POST · Q2**

Which of the 28 pulse qualities did today's lecture make most relevant to Ms. Lin's case? Name the quality, its feel, and what it confirms about her pattern.

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**POST · Q3**

Ms. Lin's night sweats occur around 1–3 AM (Liver/GB time). How does this interact with her pulse findings, and what treatment principle would the pulse support?

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**F · After-Lecture Synthesis & Self-Monitoring**

Complete this section within 24 hours of lecture for maximum retention.

| I Can Now Confidently... | Still Unclear — I Need to Review... | Connected to Other Learning... |
|--------------------------|-------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
|                          |                                     |                                |
|                          |                                     |                                |
|                          |                                     |                                |
|                          |                                     |                                |
|                          |                                     |                                |

### Concept Map Completion — 28 Pulse Qualities by Classification

Complete the table from memory. Fill in the qualities and what property each group measures.

| Classification Group | Pulse Qualities in This Group | Core Property Measured |
|----------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------|
| Depth                |                               |                        |
| Rate                 |                               |                        |
| Strength             |                               |                        |
| Size                 |                               |                        |
| Length               |                               |                        |
| Shape                |                               |                        |
| Rhythm               |                               |                        |

### Homework Tracker

#### Assigned Homework (from lecture):

- ☐ **Task 1:** Practice pulse-taking on at least 3 people before next class. Record depth, rate, strength, quality, and position-specific findings using the 6-position grid. Write up as Pulse/Tongue Journal entries.
- ☐ **Task 2:** Complete Pulse/Tongue Journal entries for this week. Tongue map + full 6-position pulse grid on every page. Entries 1–25 due at Midterm (Aug 7).
- ☐ **Task 3:** Quiz 3 prep — reproduce all 28 quality names, feels, and indications from memory. Practice seasonal pulse mnemonic until automatic. Quiz 3 is July 31.

Notes on practice / logistics:

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